

BEL signs MoU with Indian Institute of Technology Madras

Navratna Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL) and Indian Institute of Technology Madras (IITM) have entered into an MoU for research collaboration in the areas of propellants, explosives and related technologies. The MoU will enable joint research programmes in the field of explosives and propellants, visits by scientists, engineers and researchers to each other's facilities for undertaking joint research projects, knowledge sharing and capability development, among others.

NTPC to help Togo with solar power projects

NTPC Ltd is the project management consultant for the development of around 300MW of solar power projects in Togo, according to a report by the *Times of India*. The report added that the letter of engagement signed between the west African country and the Indian PSU will be the first time another country has asked NTPC for help under International Solar Alliance (ISA).

EESL, BSNL team up to install 1000 public charging stations in India

Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (EESL) has signed an MoU with Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd (BSNL) for the installation of public charging stations to boost e-mobility adoption across India. EESL will set up public charging stations in thousand BSNL sites in a phased manner on pan-India basis. It will make the entire upfront investment on the service along with operation and maintenance of the charging infrastructure with the help of qualified personnel. BSNL will look after providing the requisite space and power connections for installing the charging infrastructure.

Detel to foray in EV industry

Detel has announced its entry in electric vehicle (EV) industry in India. Having already made its mark in electronics and consumer gadgets category, the brand is set to disrupt the EV market with its unique and affordable offerings under its initiative #detelde-

carboniseindia. With this foray, Detel will bring cutting-edge products to enable consumers, businesses and governments to smoothly adopt premium electric mobility.

Ananth Technologies to build foreign-owned satellites in India

According to a report by the *Economic Times*, aerospace firm Ananth Technologies has signed deals to build six foreign-owned satellites in India. Chairman and managing director Subba Rao Pavuluri said that the company will open a full-fledged satellite making facility in Bengaluru. It will build satellites weighing between 50kg and 250kg for customers in Sweden and France in this facility.

Suzuki Motor to set up lithium-ion battery recycling facility in India

According to a report by Autocar Professional, Suzuki Motor Corp. (SMC)-backed Automotive Electronics Power Pvt Ltd (AEPPL) is planning to set up a lithium-ion battery recycling facility in India in the future. Hisashi Takeuchi, managing officer and deputy executive general manager - global automobile marketing, Suzuki Motor Corp, said that the company has adopted the system 3R (Reuse, Rebuild and Recycle) for safety and scrapping of lithium-ion batteries.

Mouser Electronics and Sony Electronics sign global agreement to distribute Spresense dev boards for IoT Edge solutions

Mouser Electronics has announced a global distribution agreement with Sony Electronics to distribute Spresense development boards for Edge computing solutions. As part of the agreement, Mouser now offers Spresense high-performance development boards, enabling designers to quickly create solutions for a diverse range of implementation areas including logistics, robotics, artificial intelligence (AI), audio and the Internet of Things (IoT).

decrease, compared to 2177MW installed in Q3 2019. However, installations were up by 15.6 per cent compared to 1641MW installed in Q4 2018. In Q4 2019, large-scale solar projects came to 1593 MW, while rooftop solar installations came to 304MW, an increase of 24.1 per cent compared to 245 MW in Q3 2019.

According to the report, multiple reasons led to the decline in large-scale solar additions in 2019, including elections, a slowing economy, liquidity issues, tariff caps, lack of financing, curtailment, payment delays and PPA renegotiations in Andhra Pradesh.

Telangana claims to save ₹ 536.7 million on electricity bills annually

Reports from Telangana claim that

the state is now saving a massive amount of ₹ 536.7 million annually on electricity bills. Officials in the state's electrical department claim that they have been able to accurately measure every single unit of power utilised in streetlighting via the most sophisticated central control and monitoring system (CCMS).

This unique system, which has been installed by select urban bodies, assists in implementing energy-efficient lighting systems. This central monitoring is done on LED streetlights that are replacing conventional lights. The central system accurately measures power consumption, and the energy utilised in the LED streetlights is thus audited online.

EESL gives tender to light up 9310 dark spots in Chandigarh

Around 9310 dark spots have been identified in Chandigarh, and these will be lit up by cutting-edge LED lights soon, states *The Tribune*. Government-owned Energy Efficiency Services Ltd (EESL) had undertaken the task of installing the lights a long time back, but even after displaying tenders numerous times, there were no takers for this project. EESL sources now say that the work will begin soon and that there is a three-month deadline to complete it.

To carry out this project, the work of installing and wiring 3000 electricity poles has been taken up by Sawhney Electricals. It seems that everything is in place, including poles and wiring, and it is just the lights that need to be installed.